

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 548

By Vital

A RESOLUTION recognizing Volunteers in Medicine,
Chattanooga, Inc., on the occasion of its
twentieth anniversary.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should specially recognize those exemplary organizations whose remarkable personnel work with purpose and conviction to improve the quality of life in their respective communities; and

WHEREAS, one such estimable organization is Volunteers in Medicine, Chattanooga, Inc., (VIM), which has provided dedicated and compassionate healthcare services to uninsured individuals in Hamilton County and surrounding counties since its opening in May 2005; and

WHEREAS, VIM has remained open through numerous challenges over the past two decades, including the COVID-19 pandemic, and continues to serve the community's most vulnerable residents with accessible and affordable primary care; and

WHEREAS, VIM's patients, who are hardworking and eager to improve their lives, have benefited greatly from the clinic's services, becoming healthier and more able to support themselves and their families; and

WHEREAS, through the generosity of the community, including foundations, churches, and individuals, VIM's free primary care clinic has been able to provide medical care at no cost to its patients, with services rendered by more than 100 dedicated volunteers, including physicians, nurses, and other clinicians; and

WHEREAS, the clinic's staff, consisting of two full-time and six part-time employees, works hand in hand in the crucial continuity-of-care approach in coordination with providers and patients; and

WHEREAS, the patient demographics served by VIM indicate that seventy percent are in their mid-fifties to sixties, eighty percent having income at or below 133 percent of the federal poverty level, and many not qualifying for Affordable Care Act policies or state Medicaid; and

WHEREAS, VIM's patients are often employed, typically in part-time work, and struggle with chronic health conditions, including heart disease, diabetes, hypertension, and obesity; and

WHEREAS, to date, VIM has provided over 82,000 patient visits, valued at \$29 million at clinic rates and nearly \$114 million at emergency room rates, along with \$20 million in dispensed medications and over \$6.5 million in donated lab services; and

WHEREAS, the commitment and selflessness of VIM's volunteers, who have contributed more than 170,000 hours of service, have been instrumental in sustaining the clinic's success and in providing quality care to those in need; and

WHEREAS, VIM's primary objective is to meet the medical needs of its patients without creating financial burdens, treating both chronic and acute health issues, and fostering a sense of dignity, worth, and hope in the lives of those served; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we specially honor this worthy organization during its twentieth anniversary year; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Volunteers in Medicine, Chattanooga, Inc., on its twentieth anniversary, thank the good people of this organization for their remarkable contributions to the health and well-being of their community, and extend our best wishes for every future success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to

the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.